

9 Sticky End India Fails to Qualify for Olympics Hockey

Indian hockey has seen it all. Good days, from 1928 to 1956 when it won six Olympic golds in a row, and the worst being its failure to even qualify for the games in 2008. A long history of maladministration and insularity on the BCCI's part led to this shocking elimination. The poor run of the national game made INDIA TODAY observe in March 2008, "Indian hockey can no longer be pined over like a lost love. It is a sick industry in need of restructuring. Otherwise let's roll up all the astro turf and lock up the stadiums."

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10 Volley Folly Bhupathi vs Paes

They were India's best hopes for an Olympic gold in tennis. But then Leander Paes and Mahesh Bhupathi decided they had had enough of each other. "The best way to deal with Bhupathi-Paes these days is to convince yourself that today for each man, the other does not exist" (INDIA TODAY, June 2008).

by Bushra Ahmed

greatest surprises

An unexpected retirement, a startling wrestling bronze. Several highs and lows stunned India.

1 Maiden Triumph 1983 World Cup Win

The year 1983 saw Indian cricket team defeating heavyweights like West Indies to hold aloft the Prudential World Cup on the balcony of cricket's Mecca, Lord's.

2 Sunny Set Gavaskar's Retirement

The world came to a standstill in August 1987 when the Indian team's pillar of strength Sunil Gavaskar—the first to amass 10,000 runs in Tests—decided to retire.

3 Advantage India

India Beats France in Davis Cup in 1993

Ramesh Krishnan and Leander Paes beat a much stronger French team to proceed to the Davis Cup's semi finals, one of the greatest upsets in Davis Cup history.

4 Match Point

Paes's Bronze in Atlanta

A lion-hearted player from Kolkata gave India its first individual Olympic medal in 44 years. Leander Paes played like a man who fires himself up by lighting matchsticks with his teeth.

5 A Long Innings

India Beats Australia in 2001

Sourav Ganguly's captaincy led India to its historic win over Australia in 2001. Steve Waugh's dream of conquering the "final frontier" eluded him.

6 A Dream Run George's World Championship Medal in 2003

Anju Bobby George's giant leap of 6.7 m got her the bronze and the title of the first Indian to ever win a World Championship medal in athletics.

7 Perfect Stroke Jeev Milkha Singh's Win

After a seven-year drought, Jeev Milkha Singh's hard work and determination finally paid off when he teed off to win the Volvo China Open in Beijing in 2006.

8 Silly Point

Bangladesh Beats India in the 2007 World Cup

Indian team's loss to minnows Bangladesh saw the country making its earliest World Cup exit since 1979 and Greg Chappell resigning as its coach.

9 Clean Sweep

T20 World Cup Victory

When M.S. Dhoni and his team returned with the T20 World Cup, an ecstatic India hailed the champions with almost the same euphoria as the historic 1983 World Cup win.

10 Fighting Fit Kumar's Beijing Bronze

Twenty-five-year-old Sushil Kumar added a surprise chapter to India's Olympic victories when he won the bronze in the 60-kg freestyle wrestling this year in Beijing.

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